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Well, it seems the internet might have spent the past few weeks complaining for nothing.

One of the [ongoing debates](#) surrounding this year's awards season was whether Paul Thomas Anderson's [One Battle After Another](#) really deserved the prizes it was amassing in the run-up to the Oscars—awards it was tipped to also sweep on Hollywood's biggest night. And the internet's ire wasn't simply limited to the question of the film's sometimes controversial politics, which touch on hot-button issues of race and sex and armed resistance. Instead, underlying much of the disappointment was the question of *at what cost?* And that cost was, as fans saw it, the trophies that should rightfully be going to Ryan Coogler's [Sinners](#)—an [unapologetically Black](#), musical, vampire horror flick—which repeatedly lost to *One Battle After Another* (and [Marty Supreme](#), and [Hamnet](#)) at the Golden Globes. This didn't bode well for the fan-favorite film of the year where potential Oscar wins were concerned, so fans lashed out in anger, whether they'd seen its opponents or not.

But Thursday morning's Oscar nominations suggested a different story. *Sinners* not only beat out all other titles in total nods, with a whopping 16, but it also set a new record for the [most nominated film in Oscars history](#). It wasn't in itself a shock that *Sinners* surpassed the all-time high. It was widely predicted that *Sinners* might break the previous record—14 nominations, set in 1951 by *All About Eve* and subsequently tied by *Titanic* and *La La Land*—especially considering it was a lock on nabbing a nomination for [Best Casting](#), the Academy Awards' first new category in more than two decades. But *Sinners* exceeded even that expectation, earning one more than needed to break the record, by securing the nominations in categories both anticipated (Best Picture, Director, Actor) and otherwise, like Best Visual Effects, and Best Supporting Actor, where 73-year-old legend of Black cinema Delroy Lindo earned a long-overdue first Oscar nomination.

And as *Sinners* galloped ahead, other movies proved unexpectedly slow out of the gate. Going into Thursday morning, many thought Best Picture would come down to *One Battle After Another*, widely considered the front-runner, and the possible spoiler [Hamnet](#), which won best drama at the Golden Globes. (*One Battle After Another* won best musical or comedy.) *Sinners*, with its history of earning plenty of nominations (seven at the Golden Globes and 17 at the Critics Choice Awards) but struggling to actually walk away with the metal statues, looked like it would spend all of awards season as the bridesmaid and never the bride.

However, *One Battle After Another*, which was believed to be [the other contender to break the previous record of 14 nominations](#), didn't even tie it, coming away one shy with 13—a number that simultaneously solidifies its status as a strong contender but suggests that it's not quite as unstoppable as pundits once thought. In particular, *One Battle* came up empty in categories like Best Makeup and Hairstyling—where voters passed over the movie's prosthetics work for Sean Penn's third-act transformation in favor of two relative unknowns, *Kokuho* and *The Ugly Stepsister*—and Best Actress, where newcomer Chase Infiniti was widely forecast to be nominated (the much-less-favored Kate Hudson grabbed one for *Song Sung Blue*).

And while *One Battle* looks perhaps slightly weaker than anticipated, most other films seem to have fallen out of contention entirely. In *Hamnet*'s case, the satisfying Lindo nomination likely won out over a nomination for Paul Mescal, who has been continuously nominated in the category at the preceding awards. *Hamnet* also got blanked in Best Editing and Best Cinematography, where, instead, *Sentimental Value* and *Marty Supreme*, both of which were considered long shots on the

awards-prediction site [GoldDerby](#), sneaked in. Best Editing, in particular, is considered one of the best predictors of a Best Picture win, and the fact that *Hamnet* wasn't even nominated puts its odds for winning Best Picture much lower: In the past 45 years, only two movies, the seamless-looking *Birdman* and the dark-horse winner *CODA*, won Best Picture without netting at least a nom for editing. This is to say nothing of the other films that didn't get the shine they were expected to either. [Marty Supreme](#) missed out on nominations for Best Supporting Actress for Odessa A'zion, Makeup and Hairstyling, and Score. [Wicked: For Good](#) drastically underperformed, earning a startling zero nominations in contrast to its predecessor's 10. On the betting market Kalshi—and yes, I hate that these are part of the awards conversation now—*Sinners* surged from a 7 percent chance of winning Best Picture to up to 22 percent, in the space of a few hours, while *One Battle* faded slightly, to down to 72 percent, and *Hamnet* cratered, from 13 percent to 4.

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So, when it comes down to it, it seems like Oscars night might really become the *Sinners* vs. *One Battle* war the fans on the internet feared. Unfortunately for Coogler stans, there's still a good chance that even with this record high number of nominations, the actual number of little gold men *Sinners* walks home with might be slim, which could lead to another round of online havoc. But, may I posit that there's something better to be angry about than *Sinners* winning or losing on awards night: How the *f*— did *F1* end up in the Best Picture category?

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